

Assignment 0: Warming up for the Clinic

Assigned: August 28

Due: September 4

In Connecticut, and more generally in the United States, “affordable” housing is generally understood to describe housing where a resident is not paying more than 30% of their income on rent or a mortgage. But what constitutes “affordable housing” and how it is provisioned varies around the world. “Affordable housing,” “social housing,” “public housing,” “mutual housing,” “cooperative housing,” are just a few ways affordable housing projects may be described in different countries, regions, and cities where they are built. Projects deploy architectural and urban strategies of varying scales, massing, typologies, and aesthetics to both represent and actuate ideas about social structure and community. They can range from a single accessory unit housing one person to developments of 50,000 or more residents.

What does good affordable housing look like to you? What do you believe your discipline’s role in the creation of affordable housing is? For our first class on Friday 4th September, we ask that you research and briefly present one example of a project which you believe represents a good and interesting example of “affordable housing,” either from the place you grew up in or from a place you have lived, while considering these two key questions. Examples can be contemporary or historical. What is it about the project that makes it interesting to you? How do you believe team members from your discipline contributed to the work? How does it achieve affordability? Some themes you might consider are: sense of community, ownership structure, financing, innovative legal strategy, sustainability and resiliency, attitude to public space, scale, density, material choice, typology, style, common spaces, setting new legal precedents, among others. Elaborate on the qualities you feel are most important to discuss. In your presentation, include the following basic information.

Project Name and Location (Neighborhood, City, State, Country, etc.)

Date Constructed

Architect and other key consultants

Developer (Public or Private)

Ownership (Co-operative, Rental, etc.)

Number of Units

Density, in Dwelling Units per Acre

Total Square Footage

Unit mix and average size (1 BR, 2 BR, etc.)

Total Construction Cost

Construction Type (brick, timber-frame, steel)

Required Readings / Watching:

Kubey, Karen, “Introduction,” in *Housing for the Common Good*. AD, July 2018, Volume 88, Issue 4, 6-13.

<https://ebookcentral-proquest-com.yale.idm.oclc.org/lib/yale-ebooks/detail.action?docID=5502971>

Fighting For Home: How Housing Policy Keeps Connecticut Segregated, 2024.

<https://www.ctpublic.org/watch/local-programming/fighting-for-home>

Yale Urban Design Workshop, Housing Clinic 2022 and 2023 publications.

Deliverables:

1. A presentation of no more than 5 slides on an affordable housing project of your choice. Plan to speak for around 2-3 minutes. Format: PDF. Make sure your name is on your presentation!

Please upload your PDF to Canvas by Friday 6st September 9am